

## Chapter 24-1

Yan Si left her contact information with the shop owner, telling him to fix the phone at any cost if it was possible.

She walked out of the phone shop in a daze, not knowing where to go.

She felt that today's events were like a dream—perhaps when she woke up, nothing would have changed.

But her muddled brain told her that everything was real. She had promised Yin Lingzhu that she would no longer cling to her.

Before she knew it, she had returned to the apartment.

The empty room had no trace of human presence.

Yan Si came to Yin Lingzhu's room. Nothing was left behind—even traces of having lived there were sparse.

At the time, to avoid Yin Lingzhu discovering the surveillance, when Yin Lingzhu had said she wanted to renovate the house, Yan Si had strongly opposed it.

She looked at the laptop she had just brought over. In the surveillance camera feed, she sat desolately in the room.

There were no important files on that phone, but all her chat records with Yin Lingzhu were stored in that phone.

If she couldn't even preserve a copy of their chat records, what else of Yin Lingzhu's could she hold onto?

Yan Si's hands seemed beyond her control as she switched perspectives and opened the dormitory where Yin Lingzhu now lived.

In the dormitory, Yin Lingzhu and Wan Miaoyin were discussing future programs when she suddenly felt an intense gaze.

Following her instincts, Yin Lingzhu looked up—it was that camera.

She frowned in displeasure and casually picked up a piece of clothing to cover the camera.

Yan Si watched as Yin Lingzhu grew larger and larger on the computer screen. When Yin Lingzhu finally looked at the camera, it was as if she were looking directly at her.

Yan Si's heart raced wildly. That glance fell into her heart, and the emotions of fear and excitement coexisting made it impossible for Yan Si's brain to think about anything else.

But then the computer screen went completely dark.

Yan Si's surging emotions instantly froze.

"Why did you suddenly cover the camera?" Wan Miaoyin asked.

Yin Lingzhu shook her head slightly and sat back in her original position, "Nothing, it's just that having a camera there feels uncomfortable."

The voices of the two came through the audio system, reaching Yan Si's ears with perfect clarity.

Yan Si couldn't help but recall the words Yin Lingzhu had said to her—not to cling to her anymore.

Yan Si's reason told her she should let go, should listen properly to Yin Lingzhu's words. She had already promised Yin Lingzhu.

But her current instincts told her that if she let go, there would truly be no possibility left between her and Yin Lingzhu.

The sounds of Yin Lingzhu and Wan Miaoyin's conversation rose up, accompanied by occasional laughter. Yan Si felt as if the world before her eyes was spinning.

Yan Si's vision went black, just like the computer screen that had been blocked, and she fainted.

At the moment she fainted, Yin Lingzhu seemed to sense something and looked up at the camera.

"What's wrong?" Wan Miaoyin followed her gaze but found nothing—the clothing covered the camera tightly.

"I don't know either, it's nothing." Yin Lingzhu couldn't explain the feeling she'd just had and attributed it to her own hallucination.

"Then it's decided—we'll use sequins on stage." Wan Miaoyin said, confirming the stage effects.

"Mm, let's go with that. I'm a bit tired." Yin Lingzhu nodded. Her heart was palpitating severely right now, and her brain couldn't function properly.

Wan Miaoyin noticed something was wrong with her and said gently, "Go rest on the bed for a while."

Hearing her say this, Yin Lingzhu nodded.

Wan Miaoyin had been so excited earlier, clearly loving the stage performance, but because of her condition, she had hastily decided on the stage matters.

Yin Lingzhu felt a bit embarrassed and was about to say something when Wan Miaoyin spoke first, "It's fine, rest well. We still have several days before the official performance."

After that, Yin Lingzhu lay in bed while Wan Miaoyin went out.

"What's wrong? Are you sick?" Kong Murui pushed the door open and saw Yin Lingzhu lying on the bed, asking with confusion.

Yin Lingzhu shook her head, realizing the other person probably couldn't see from that angle, "Nothing, I just suddenly felt dizzy."

Seeing Kong Murui climb onto the bed, Yin Lingzhu asked what she had been doing all afternoon since she hadn't seen her around.

The answer was that she had gone on a date.

Yin Lingzhu looked at her in surprise, "The company doesn't allow dating."

And Kong Murui didn't seem like someone who had a partner either.

Yin Lingzhu thought this silently but didn't dare say it out loud.

"Rules are dead, but people are alive." Kong Murui said, "Besides, Sister Yang knows about it."

Yin Lingzhu was surprised again.

After waiting a while, Yin Lingzhu finally spoke, "You and your partner have such a good relationship."

Talking about this topic, Kong Murui seemed to open up like a floodgate.

"Yes, my partner is also super good to me." Kong Murui talked about a bunch of her partner's good qualities. From the smile on her face, it wasn't hard to see just how happy she was.

"How did you and your partner meet?" Yin Lingzhu couldn't help but sigh with emotion.

"At a dance party. I fell in love with her at first sight, then pursued her relentlessly until she agreed to be with me." Kong Murui spoke about her with animated gestures, her hands constantly moving as she described.

Watching her happy expression, Yin Lingzhu couldn't help but recall her first meeting with Yan Si.

Her situation with Yan Si had been similar, but she hadn't been as lucky as Kong Murui.

From this afternoon's situation, it seemed that she and Yan Si would never have any relationship again in the future.

Although her heart still ached a little, Yin Lingzhu was willing to endure momentary pain rather than continue entangling with Yan Si in an unclear relationship.

Life remained peaceful for the next several days, and Yin Lingzhu didn't see Yan Si.

On stage, Yin Lingzhu was performing energetically. Countless sequins fell from above the stage, swirling around her. One accidentally fell onto the back of her neck.

Yin Lingzhu felt that sequin, but there was nothing she could do. On stage, she could only endure the strange sensation.

After leaving the stage, Yin Lingzhu quickly rushed backstage, wanting to change out of her costume.

She felt that now it wasn't just one sequin—many sequins had flown in through her collar and were sticking to the skin around the back of her neck.

At this moment, all of Yin Lingzhu's senses were focused on the back of her neck, which was a very sensitive area.

There were many staff members backstage. Suddenly, someone appeared with a water bottle in hand, pouring it straight toward Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu had been distracted by the sequins on the back of her neck, which had captured all her attention. By the time she noticed, it was too late.

The liquid from the bottle had already traced an arc through the air, rushing toward Yin Lingzhu.

At the last moment, Yan Si suddenly appeared, protecting Yin Lingzhu in her embrace and using her back to block the liquid.

Feeling the pain on her back, Yan Si let out a muffled groan.

Yin Lingzhu found herself completely embraced, frozen in place.

Hearing the sound Yan Si made, she finally snapped back to reality.

She quickly broke free from Yan Si's embrace, took large steps to catch up with the person trying to escape, and kicked them in the back of the knee.

That person immediately fell to their knees, and Yin Lingzhu snatched the bottle from their hands.

All of this happened in the blink of an eye.

The production crew reacted and immediately sent Yan Si to the hospital.

Yan Si's eyes never left Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu's gaze collided with hers, then quickly looked away.

Why had Yan Si come out to help her? What was the point of being a cold-blooded bystander?

Yin Lingzhu thought irritably as she looked at the bottle in her hand. The transparent, viscous liquid inside couldn't even reflect light in the sunlight.

Yan Si handed this over to the staff. She knew the production crew would definitely investigate thoroughly—how could they let the matter slide easily when a movie queen was injured on their set?

In the hospital, Yan Si lay prone on the bed with a large area of burns on her back.

Her entire upper body was wrapped in bandages as she lay on the bed, looking completely disheveled.

Through the door crack, Yin Lingzhu could see most of the scene inside.

She had intended to knock before entering, but she saw that in the spacious hospital room, there wasn't just Yan Si as a patient—there was another person standing beside Yan Si's bed.

It was Si Xin.

Yin Lingzhu smiled mockingly. Her gaze fell on the fruit basket in her hands.

All the fruit baskets around the production crew had been bought up. Because of Yan Si's hospitalization, everyone wanted to curry favor with her.

This fruit basket was one she had found after running far from the production crew, asking shop after shop until she found one that had them for sale.

But seeing this now, it was still all in vain. Yan Si had so many people who cared about her—she wasn't lacking this one.

Yin Lingzhu pushed open the door, and Yan Si beamed at her with a smile.

Yan Si knew that with Yin Lingzhu's personality, she would definitely come to see her.

Yin Lingzhu put down the fruit basket, left behind the words "rest well," and departed.

Yan Si watched her actions, not expecting her to leave so quickly.

Her words came too late to be spoken, and the smile on her face froze directly there. Yin Lingzhu had already closed the door from outside.

Yan Si noticed the fruit basket she had brought—it should have been carefully selected.

"President Yan, you—" Si Xin's words stuck in her throat as she saw Yan Si's eyes staring deadly at her.

Si Xin stepped back a small step, gripping the bed rail weakly.

When Yin Lingzhu was still outside the door, Yan Si had already sensed it. She had specifically adjusted her posture, hoping Yin Lingzhu would see her in good form.

Yan Si could also see that Yin Lingzhu's attitude had changed after seeing Si Xin.

She hoped that when Yin Lingzhu saw her, she might smile or even hate her—anything but coldly putting down a fruit basket and leaving.

"Leave." Yan Si coldly spat out one word.

Looking at her expression, Si Xin bit her lip, unable to say anything, and still left.

After leaving, Yin Lingzhu wandered aimlessly on the street.

She didn't know where she should go. Now she only had the dormitory and the hotel—she could only stay in these two places.

If she suddenly disappeared, who would be sad?

Just as she was lost in thought, her phone suddenly received a message.

It was from an unknown number, sending her a photo—a photo of Yan Si.

In the picture, Yan Si looked very beautiful, wearing a khaki coat draped over her body, her hair falling on her shoulders, her eyes looking tenderly at the camera, her lips containing a gentle smile.

She looked just like a married little wife.

Yin Lingzhu's finger mysteriously pressed the save button.

Her fingers tapped on the screen, wanting to ask about the other party's purpose.

But the other party's message came faster than her typing.

【Stop clinging to President Yan. The person she likes is me.】

Looking at the words on the screen, Yin Lingzhu deleted what she had just typed.

She replaced it with different words.

【She and I already have no relationship whatsoever. Do as you please.】

Yin Lingzhu had already guessed who this person was. There were only so many people who knew about her relationship with Yan Si.

The only person who could say such things to her was Si Xin.

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### Footnotes:

None needed for this chapter as the cultural elements are consistent with previous translations.